



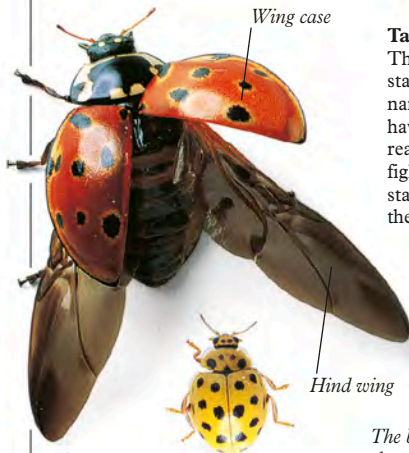
BEETLES



There are more species of beetles in the world than any other kind of animal. It is thought there are at least 300,000. Most are plant-eaters, but some battling beetles attack and eat other insects and are quite ferocious. Beetles can be pests because they eat valuable crops. But mostly they are helpful to us because they eat dead plants and animals and return them to the Earth as important nutrients.

Ready for battle

A beetle's hard outer casing acts like a protective armor.



Wing case

Hind wing

Garden visitor

Ladybugs are beetles, too. Not all beetles can fly but ladybugs can. They use their hind wings to fly.

Take that!

These fighting beetles are stag beetles. They get their name because male stag beetles have large "horns." These are really large jaws that are used for fighting like the antlers of a real stag. Males fight to defend their territory.

The forewings are turned into tough wing cases that protect the delicate hind wings.

The beetle's claws help it to grip.

